
A COMPLETE RESOURCE FOR FAMILIES MOVING TO DFW

The DFW Family *Relocation Guide*

Schools · Suburbs · Commutes · Cost of Living · Community

*Everything your family needs to know before choosing a DFW suburb —
the information nobody gives you until after you've signed the papers.*

Kristen Carpentier

DFW FAMILY RELOCATION SPECIALIST · TEXAS REALTOR® #760457

01

A NOTE FROM KRISTEN

Welcome, Family



Hi, I'm
Kristen.

I'm a licensed Texas Realtor® and DFW family relocation specialist — and I've been helping families move to Dallas–Fort Worth from California, New York, Illinois, and beyond for years.

I built this guide because relocating families kept asking me the same questions. And honestly? They deserved better answers than what was out there.

What's in here is the real stuff: which suburbs actually work for families with school-age kids, what the school districts are really like, how property taxes work, and how to navigate buying a home from 1,500 miles away.

I'm a mom of four. I've raised my family right here in DFW. I know what it feels like to want to get this decision right — because it's not just a house, it's the school your kids will walk into, the neighborhood they'll grow up in, the community that'll become yours. I'm here to make sure you get there confidently.

— **Kristen**
DFW Family Relocation Specialist

TOOLS I'VE BUILT FOR YOUR SEARCH

whymovetodallas.com

Full suburb guides with school data, commute maps, and cost-of-living breakdowns for every suburb in this guide. IDX-powered home search so you can browse active listings by suburb, school district, price, and features — updated in real time from the MLS.

YouTube: @whymovetodallas

I've filmed driving tours of every suburb in this guide. Watch before your scouting trip — most families tell me the videos saved them an entire visit. You'll see the neighborhoods, hear my honest commentary, and get a feel for daily life that photos can't convey.

Suburb Match Quiz

A data-driven quiz on our website that asks about your commute, budget, school priorities, and lifestyle preferences — then scores all 60+ DFW suburbs against your answers. It's the same framework I use in our initial phone call, available 24/7.

REACH KRISTEN DIRECTLY

(602) 405-4115 — Call or Text · Kristen@SocialAgentGroup.com · whymovetodallas.com

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THE CASE FOR THE MOVE

Why Families Choose DFW



Let's start with the question I get most often: **"Is Dallas really as good as everyone says?"** The honest answer is — it depends on what your family is looking for. But if you're coming from California, New York, or Illinois? The math is hard to argue with.

0%

Texas State Income Tax

8M+

People in the DFW Metroplex

#1

U.S. Metro for Corporate Relocations

What California, New York & Illinois Families Gain

CATEGORY	CA / NY / IL	DFW, TEXAS
State Income Tax	9.3–13.3% (CA) · 6–10.9% (NY)	0% — None
Median Home Price	\$800K–\$1.2M+ (major metros)	\$450K–\$650K (family suburbs)
Property Tax Rate	0.6–1.0% (CA) — capped	~2.0–2.5% (offset by no income tax)
Space / Lot Size	Small lots, limited yard	Large lots, new construction common
Public School Quality	Variable, often overcrowded	Multiple A-rated ISDs ranked nationally
Cost of Living Index	150–200+ (100 = national avg)	~105–115 in family suburbs

THE TEXAS PROPERTY TAX REALITY

Texas property taxes look high on paper — typically 2.0% to 2.5% of assessed value. But here's what the calculator often misses: you're not paying state income tax. A family earning \$200,000/year saves \$13,000–\$20,000+ annually versus California or New York. Even with higher property taxes on a \$600K home (~\$13,500/year), most families come out significantly ahead. And Texas has a **Homestead Exemption** that reduces your taxable value — apply for it the year you close.

Why Families Stay Once They're Here

The practical math brings families to DFW. What keeps them is harder to quantify: the community. DFW suburbs have a genuine culture of youth sports, neighborhood events, and school involvement that families from coastal cities consistently say surprised them. There's space — physical space in your home and yard, and social space to actually connect with your neighbors. The legendary Texas friendliness isn't a cliché. It's one of the first things relocating families notice.

Weekend life here revolves around family: Friday night football games that bring entire towns together, Saturday morning soccer leagues at pristine community parks, Sunday brunch at locally-owned restaurants where the staff knows your kids' names. The pace is different from LA or Manhattan — and for families with young children, that's exactly the point.

03

BEFORE YOU PICK A SUBURB

How to Choose the Right Fit

Here's what I tell every family in our first conversation: **there is no universally "best" suburb in DFW.** There's only the best suburb for your family's specific mix of priorities. Answer these four questions honestly — the suburb list almost selects itself.

1. Where Will You Work?

Your office location anchors everything. DFW traffic is manageable — but only if you're on the right side of it.

Toyota HQ → Plano, Frisco, Allen · American Airlines → Southlake, Coppell, Flower Mound · JPMorgan/Schwab → Plano, McKinney · Remote → Any suburb works

2. What Do You Need in Schools?

Not all "A-rated" ISDs are the same. Your priorities matter.

Prestige + athletics → Carroll ISD · STEM/gifted → Frisco, Coppell ISD · Quality + value → Allen, McKinney ISD · Small + elite → Argyle ISD

3. What's Your Budget?

DFW has something at every price point — but character varies by suburb.

\$400K–\$600K → Allen, McKinney, Celina · \$600K–\$900K → Frisco, Flower Mound, Coppell · \$900K+ → Southlake, Colleyville, West Plano

4. What Vibe Does Your Family Want?

Beyond the data, it's about daily life feel.

Walkable town square → McKinney, Southlake · Master-planned → Prosper, Celina, Argyle · Quiet established → Colleyville, Highland Village · Outdoor/nature → Flower Mound, Allen

MY HONEST ADVICE

Don't pick a suburb from a list. Call me. A 20-minute conversation will tell me more about the right fit for your family than any quiz or ranking. I'll give you three suburbs to seriously consider, and tell you honestly why each one might not be the right fit too. **(602) 405-4115 or**

Kristen@SocialAgentGroup.com

04

12 SUBURBS, DATA-SCORED & HONESTLY REVIEWED

The Suburb Profiles

I've driven every one of these suburbs more times than I can count. Below you'll find each suburb's **Family Score** and **Value Score** — computed from real data including school ratings, safety metrics, demographics, market conditions, and community factors. These scores give you an objective starting point. My commentary gives you the rest.

SCORE METHODOLOGY

How Scores Work: Family Score (0–100) weighs education, safety, family-friendliness, commute, and community. Value Score (0–100) measures what you get per dollar. Data: Census ACS 2023, Niche.com, NTREIS MLS (May 2026), Walk Score.

AT A GLANCE — ALL 12 SUBURBS COMPARED

SUBURB	FAMILY	VALUE	ISD	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY
Frisco	81	80	A+	\$680,752	B-
Prosper	80	68	A	\$845,429	B+
Southlake	83	48	A+	\$1,352,688	B
Flower Mound	79	88	A	\$619,458	B+
Coppell	79	85	A+	\$625,167	B
McKinney	77	92	A	\$496,150	B-
Allen	81	93	A+	\$519,735	B
Plano	75	88	A	\$525,231	B-
Celina	75	95	B+	\$531,662	B-
Argyle	84	96	A+	\$569,414	B+
Colleyville	76	56	A+	\$1,002,479	B+
Highland Village	81	89	A	\$618,076	B+

Each profile includes sub-score breakdowns, a detailed writeup, strengths and tradeoffs, Niche.com city grades, and a "Best For" summary. Profiles are organized roughly by price tier — premium suburbs first, best value picks last. Don't skip based on budget alone.

COLLIN COUNTY

Frisco

Frisco ISD

81	80	A+	\$680,752	B-
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY



"The suburb everyone's heard of — and for good reason. DFW's crown jewel for families who want everything in one place."

Frisco is one of the fastest-growing cities in America, and it's easy to see why families choose it. The school district is top-tier, the amenities are extraordinary (The Star — the Dallas Cowboys' world headquarters — is here), and the infrastructure has kept pace with the growth in a way few cities manage. New restaurants, shopping, parks, and community events are constant.

EDUCATION	97
SAFETY	80
COMMUNITY	69
COMMUTE	51
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Frisco ISD (A+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$680,752
DAYS ON MARKET	37.7 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$146,158
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	47.3%
WALK SCORE	80
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Families who want the full package — top schools, great restaurants, strong community, and don't mind paying for it.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B-	A+	B-	A	A

COLLIN COUNTY

Prosper

Prosper ISD

80	68	A	\$845,429	B+
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"Frisco's quieter, newer neighbor — master-planned communities with resort amenities that feel almost too good to be true."

Prosper sits just north of Frisco and is one of the most impressive new construction markets in DFW. The master-planned communities here are extraordinary — on-site elementary schools, resort-style pools, event lawns, fitness centers, and in one community, a crystal-clear lagoon. The school district is elite and still growing.

EDUCATION	93
SAFETY	87
COMMUNITY	73
COMMUTE	46
MARKET STABILITY	93

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Prosper ISD (A)
MEDIAN HOME	\$845,429
DAYS ON MARKET	58.1 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$187,603
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	57.7%
WALK SCORE	40
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Families who want new construction, maximum amenities, and top-tier schools — willing to be slightly farther out.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B+	A+	B	B+	A

TARRANT COUNTY

Southlake

Carroll ISD

83	48	A+	\$1,352,688	B
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY



"DFW's prestige address. Carroll ISD is one of the highest-rated school districts in the entire country."

Southlake is in a category of its own. Carroll ISD is consistently ranked among the very best school districts nationally. Southlake Town Square is one of the finest walkable commercial districts in DFW. The homes are larger, the lots are bigger, and the community is tightly connected around Dragon football and a shared sense of excellence.

EDUCATION	97	COUNTY	Tarrant County
SAFETY	83	SCHOOL DISTRICT	Carroll ISD (A+)
COMMUNITY	82	MEDIAN HOME	\$1,352,688
COMMUTE	45	DAYS ON MARKET	23.2 days
MARKET STABILITY	100	MEDIAN INCOME	\$250,001
		FAMILIES W/ KIDS	50%
		WALK SCORE	69
		MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR High-earning families where school prestige is non-negotiable and budget is not the primary constraint.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B	A+	B	B-	A

DENTON COUNTY

Flower Mound

Lewisville ISD

79	88	A	\$619,458	B+
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY



"My backyard — literally. This is where I raised my family. It still has a small-town feel despite being 30 minutes from everything."

Flower Mound consistently earns recognition as one of the safest and most family-friendly cities in DFW. It has 680 acres of parks, miles of trails including the lakeside River Walk, Grapevine Lake access, and an established community that doesn't feel like a construction zone. Marcus High School has a legendary athletics and fine arts program.

EDUCATION	93	COUNTY	Denton County
SAFETY	87	SCHOOL DISTRICT	Lewisville ISD (A)
COMMUNITY	61	MEDIAN HOME	\$619,458
COMMUTE	48	DAYS ON MARKET	23.8 days
MARKET STABILITY	100	MEDIAN INCOME	\$157,737
		FAMILIES W/ KIDS	40.7%
		WALK SCORE	5
		MARKET	Seller

BEST FOR Families who want safety, outdoor access, and established neighborhoods. Commuters to DFW Airport.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B+	A+	B	B+	A+

DALLAS COUNTY

Coppell

Coppell ISD

79	85	A+	\$625,167	B
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"One of the most underrated suburbs in DFW. Coppell ISD is exceptional, and you're 10 minutes from the airport."

Coppell is a well-kept secret among families who prioritize school quality and location. Coppell ISD is consistently ranked in the top five school districts in DFW, with strong academics, fine arts, and athletics. The city is compact and established — everyone knows their neighbors. If you travel frequently, nothing beats the commute.

EDUCATION	97
SAFETY	83
COMMUNITY	55
COMMUTE	53
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Dallas County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Coppell ISD (A+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$625,167
DAYS ON MARKET	23.6 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$139,227
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	41.7%
WALK SCORE	23
MARKET	Seller

BEST FOR Families where school quality is the #1 priority and who travel frequently. Airport proximity is unmatched.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOB
A+	B	A+	B	A	A

COLLIN COUNTY

McKinney

McKinney ISD

77	92	A	\$496,150	B-
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY



"The suburb California families fall in love with — charming historic downtown and room to breathe at a price that makes the math work."

McKinney consistently wins 'Best Place to Live' rankings and it's not hard to see why. The historic downtown square is genuinely charming — a rarity in DFW. The housing market offers real value at a price point that makes families from high-cost states feel like they've won. McKinney ISD is solid and growing.

EDUCATION	93
SAFETY	80
COMMUNITY	54
COMMUTE	54
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	McKinney ISD (A)
MEDIAN HOME	\$496,150
DAYS ON MARKET	41.9 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$120,273
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	42.8%
WALK SCORE	65
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Families from California or New York who want the most space and quality of life per dollar.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B-	A+	B	A	A

COLLIN COUNTY

Allen

Allen ISD

81	93	A+	\$519,735	B
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"The smart shopper's alternative to Frisco — similar school quality, established community, lower price."

Allen sits right next to Plano and Frisco but often gets overlooked. That's a mistake. Allen ISD is legitimately excellent, and Allen High School's athletics program is legendary (the football stadium alone gets national press). The city is established enough to have mature trees and character, but not so old that homes feel dated.

EDUCATION	97
SAFETY	83
COMMUNITY	66
COMMUTE	50
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Allen ISD (A+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$519,735
DAYS ON MARKET	33.4 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$129,130
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	42.4%
WALK SCORE	67
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Families who want Frisco-quality schools and community at a friendlier price point.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B	A+	B	A	A+

COLLIN COUNTY

Plano

Plano ISD

75	88	A	\$525,231	B-
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"The corporate relocation capital of DFW — Toyota, JPMorgan, and dozens of Fortune 500s are here."

Plano is DFW's established corporate hub and has been a top destination for relocating families for decades. Plano ISD is one of the most diverse and well-resourced districts in Texas. West Plano in particular has some of DFW's most beautiful established neighborhoods with mature trees and larger lots.

EDUCATION	93
SAFETY	80
COMMUNITY	43
COMMUTE	54
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Plano ISD (A)
MEDIAN HOME	\$525,231
DAYS ON MARKET	30.1 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$108,649
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	32.8%
WALK SCORE	92
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Corporate transferees to Toyota, JPMorgan, or other Legacy/West Plano employers.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B-	A+	B-	A	A

COLLIN COUNTY

Celina

Celina ISD

75	95	B+	\$531,662	B-
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"The best value in new construction right now. Growing fast, but still has that 'know your neighbor' charm."

Celina is one of the fastest-growing cities in America — and smart buyers are noticing. You get a newer home at a meaningfully lower price than Prosper or Frisco, with a genuine small-town character that larger suburbs have lost. The growth in the North Dallas corridor almost guarantees strong home appreciation here.

EDUCATION	87
SAFETY	80
COMMUNITY	69
COMMUTE	47
MARKET STABILITY	82

COUNTY	Collin County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Celina ISD (B+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$531,662
DAYS ON MARKET	69.2 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$155,875
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	55.3%
WALK SCORE	65
MARKET	Buyer

BEST FOR Families who want maximum home for their dollar and love new construction. Remote workers.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A	B-	A+	B	A-	A+

DENTON COUNTY

Argyle

Argyle ISD

84	96	A+	\$569,414	B+
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"Pecan Square and Harvest are two of the best master-planned communities in all of DFW — and Argyle ISD is quietly elite."

Argyle sits northwest of Flower Mound and offers a rare combination: master-planned community living with a rural, open feel. Pecan Square and Harvest are destination communities — families drive from neighboring towns just to see them. Argyle ISD is small but mighty, consistently outperforming much larger districts.

EDUCATION	97
SAFETY	87
COMMUNITY	76
COMMUTE	55
MARKET STABILITY	98

COUNTY	Denton County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Argyle ISD (A+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$569,414
DAYS ON MARKET	52.9 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$172,604
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	39%
WALK SCORE	26
MARKET	Balanced

BEST FOR Families who want master-planned community living with an open, rural feel and elite schools.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B+	A+	B	B-	A

TARRANT COUNTY

Colleyville

Grapevine-Colleyville ISD

76	56	A+	\$1,002,479	B+
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"The peaceful middle ground between Southlake's prestige and Flower Mound's outdoorsy vibe. Larger lots, mature neighborhoods."

Colleyville is the suburb for families who want established elegance without Southlake's price tag or intensity. Spacious ranch and farmhouse-style homes on larger lots sit in neighborhoods with real character. Its location between Dallas and Fort Worth makes it genuinely central for dual-commute families.

EDUCATION	97
SAFETY	87
COMMUNITY	36
COMMUTE	55
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Tarrant County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Grapevine-Colleyville ISD (A+)
MEDIAN HOME	\$1,002,479
DAYS ON MARKET	19.1 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$203,566
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	37.1%
WALK SCORE	64
MARKET	Seller

BEST FOR Families wanting Southlake-adjacent prestige at a slightly lower price, with larger lots.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B+	A+	B+	B	A

DENTON COUNTY

Highland Village

Lewisville ISD

81	89	A	\$618,076	B+
FAMILY SCORE	VALUE SCORE	ISD RATING	MEDIAN HOME	SAFETY

"Flower Mound's quieter, lake-adjacent sister. Families who find Highland Village rarely leave."

Highland Village wraps around Lake Lewisville and offers one of the most peaceful residential experiences in DFW. The neighborhoods are well-established, homes sit on larger lots, and the lake access is unmatched. The Shops at Highland Village give residents a local commercial hub without driving to a big corridor.

EDUCATION	93
SAFETY	87
COMMUNITY	70
COMMUTE	47
MARKET STABILITY	100

COUNTY	Denton County
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Lewisville ISD (A)
MEDIAN HOME	\$618,076
DAYS ON MARKET	25.7 days
MEDIAN INCOME	\$164,459
FAMILIES W/ KIDS	43.6%
WALK SCORE	1
MARKET	Seller

BEST FOR Families who want a quiet, lake-adjacent community with top safety ratings.

NICHE.COM CITY GRADES

PUBLIC SCHOOLS	CRIME	FAMILIES	COST OF LIVING	DIVERSITY	JOBS
A+	B+	A+	B	B	A

05

FOR FAMILIES WITH SCHOOL-AGE KIDS

The School District Deep Dive

Every family I work with asks about schools. And they should — because in DFW, the school district you're in can be as important as the house itself. Here's my honest breakdown of the ISDs that matter most for relocating families.

SCHOOL DISTRICT	GRADE	SERVES	KNOWN FOR	BEST FIT
Carroll ISD	A+	Southlake	National rankings, Dragon athletics	Prestige + athletics priority
Coppell ISD	A+	Coppell	STEM, fine arts, tight community	Academics-driven; frequent travelers
Frisco ISD	A+	Frisco, parts of Prosper	Scale + quality, gifted programs	Proven quality at scale
Argyle ISD	A+	Argyle, parts of Northlake	Small-district intimacy, top-ranked	Community feel over size
Allen ISD	A+	Allen	Athletics (Eagle Stadium), strong academics	School spirit + solid academics
Prosper ISD	A	Prosper, parts of McKinney	Fastest-growing, new facilities	New construction families
Plano ISD	A	Plano	Diverse, large, strong IB/AP programs	Corporate transferees near Plano
Lewisville ISD	A	Flower Mound, Highland Village	Large HS fine arts + athletics	West DFW corridor families
GCISD	A	Colleyville, Grapevine	Consistent quality, arts programs	Families between Dallas & FW
McKinney ISD	A	McKinney	Growing, improving, good value	Value-focused; check campus ratings
Celina ISD	B+	Celina	Growing, building capacity	Budget-minded new construction

IMPORTANT NOTE ON SCHOOL RATINGS

State ratings and online scores are a starting point, not the whole story. A district rated A overall can have significant variation between elementary campuses. When we narrow down your suburb, I'll give you the specific campus data — not just the district average. **Ask me about any specific campus: (602) 405-4115**

06

WHAT NOBODY TELLS YOU UNTIL AFTER YOU'VE MOVED

Texas Essentials

These are the things I tell every out-of-state family before they close on a home in Texas. Some are financial. Some are practical. All of them matter.

\$0

STATE INCOME TAX

Texas has no state income tax. Period. For a family earning \$200K/year, that's \$13,000–\$25,000 in annual savings versus California or New York.

~\$

HOMESTEAD EXEMPTION

Apply for your Homestead Exemption the year you close. It reduces your taxable property value by at least \$100,000. Deadline is April 30.

2–2.5%

PROPERTY TAX REALITY

Texas property taxes are real — approximately 2–2.5% of assessed value annually. On a \$600K home, that's roughly \$12,000–\$15,000/year. But when you factor in zero state income tax and lower home prices, most families still come out ahead.

HOA

COMMUNITY ASSOCIATIONS

Most DFW suburbs — especially new construction — have HOAs. Fees range from \$500 to \$3,000+/year. Master-planned communities with pools, parks, and event spaces typically run higher.

Jun–Sep

TEXAS SUMMERS

Texas summers are legitimately hot — 100°F+ days are common June through September. Budget for higher electricity bills. The good news: winters are mild, and spring/fall are beautiful.

TX

DRIVER'S LICENSE & REGISTRATION

Texas requires you to get a TX driver's license and register your vehicles within 90 days of establishing residency. Plan for this early — DMV appointments can back up.

07

STEP BY STEP

The DFW Home Buying Process

Here's exactly what the process looks like for families relocating from out of state. I've walked hundreds of families through this — many without ever setting foot in DFW before their offer was accepted.

1

Connect with Kristen

Call, text, or email — we'll spend 20–30 minutes on your family's priorities, timeline, and budget. By the end, you'll have 2–3 suburbs to seriously consider and honest reasons why each might not be right.

(602) 405-4115

2

Get Pre-Approved

TX difference: Pre-approval (not pre-qualification) matters here. Texas has unique home equity lending rules (Article XVI, Sec. 50). A strong letter from a local lender can win over a higher offer with weak financing. I work with DFW lenders who specialize in out-of-state buyers.

3

Plan Your Scouting Trip(s)

I recommend **1–2 trips**. Trip 1: drive suburbs, visit schools, feel the commute. Trip 2: see homes — 4–5/day max, 8 total. If travel isn't possible, I do full video walkthroughs via FaceTime/Zoom showing what photos can't: lot grade, traffic noise, neighbor proximity, natural light.

4

Making an Offer

TX difference: Texas uses an **Option Fee** (\$100–\$500) for an unrestricted right to terminate during the option period — unique and buyer-friendly. **Earnest Money** (1–2%) goes to the title company. Unlike CA/NY, title companies handle closings, not attorneys. I negotiate hard on your behalf.

5

Option Period & Inspections

TX difference: 5–10 day option period — walk away for *any reason*, lose only the option fee. More flexible than CA/NY contingency periods. I always recommend a **termite inspection** (DFW clay soil), plus foundation, HVAC, and roof (hail damage is common). Trusted inspectors in every suburb.

6

Closing Day — Welcome to Texas!

Most DFW closings happen in **30 days or less** (vs. 45–60 in CA/NY). Out-of-state buyers close remotely via RON (Remote Online Notarization). After closing: file your **Homestead Exemption** immediately, get your TX license within 90 days, choose your electricity provider (deregulated market). I don't disappear — I'll connect you with everything you need to settle in.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Let's Find Your *Family's Suburb*

You've done the research. Now let's have a real conversation. Twenty minutes on the phone will tell us more about where your family belongs than any guide ever could — and I'll give you honest answers, not a sales pitch.



CALL OR TEXT

(602) 405-4115

EMAIL

Kristen@SocialAgentGroup.com

WEBSITE

whymovetodallas.com

YOUTUBE

youtube.com/@whymovetodallas

WATCH THE SUBURB TOURS ON YOUTUBE

I've filmed every suburb in this guide. Watch the full neighborhood walkthroughs, school district breakdowns, and cost-of-living comparisons before your scouting trip.

youtube.com/@whymovetodallas**Kristen Carpentier · DFW Family Relocation Specialist**

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